

Errata

On Coppock, Ekins and Kirby (2018), *Quarterly Journal of Political Science* 13(1)

This note lists six corrections to “The Long-lasting Effects of Newspaper Op-Eds on Public Opinion,” published in the *Quarterly Journal of Political Science* 13(1), doi [10.1561/100.00016112](https://doi.org/10.1561/100.00016112). **None of them changes a conclusion of the paper.** Every one is a sentence in the body text that disagrees with a table the same article prints, and in each case the table is right and the sentence is not. The tables themselves, and the findings they carry, are unaffected.

Every number in a corrected sentence below is computed from the deposited replication archive ([10.7910/DVN/3KBCJF](https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/3KBCJF)) at the time this document is rendered, including the numbers that were not wrong. The code and output supporting each correction are at github.com/active-maintenance-aec/coppock_ekins_kirby_2018.

Bold marks what changed. The first three entries are substantive: a comparison that reverses direction on one of four op-eds, a significance level overstated by an order of magnitude, and a miscount of the cells of a table. The last three are undercounted sample sizes, each of which the adjacent table gives correctly.

1. The elite sample did not read for 25 to 45 seconds less

On average, our elite sample spent 25–45 seconds less time reading our treatment articles than the MTurk sample.

Corrected:

On average, our elite sample spent **17.4** seconds less time reading our treatment articles than the MTurk sample.

Across the four op-eds both samples saw, the elite deficit in trimmed mean reading time is 45.6 seconds on the flat tax piece, 28.5 seconds on the Wall Street piece and 26.4 seconds on the Amtrak piece, and on the veterans piece the elite sample spent 30.7 seconds **more**, not less. The published range brackets the two arms the deposit’s `opeds_compliance.R` computes, the Amtrak and flat tax pieces; the two it does not compute are the ones that break the range.

2. The elite main-effect significance level

Turning first to main dependent variables, we found statistically significant treatment effects for three of the four treatments (Amtrak, Flat Tax, Wall Street) at $p < 0.001$, but did not for the Veterans op-ed treatment.

Corrected:

Turning first to main dependent variables, we found statistically significant treatment effects for three of the four treatments (Amtrak, Flat Tax, Wall Street) at $p < \mathbf{0.01}$, but did not for the Veterans op-ed treatment.

The flat tax effect on its main dependent variable has $p = 0.0042$. Table 6 prints it as $0.411***$ under a legend whose strongest level is $p < 0.01$, so the table and the sentence disagree about the same estimate. The Amtrak and Wall Street effects are significant at 0.001; the flat tax effect is not.

3. Table 7 has twelve non-target cells, not sixteen

Of the 16 treatment effects on non-target issues, only one is statistically significant (Amtrak op-ed on Veterans outcome).

Corrected:

Of the **12** treatment effects on non-target issues, only one is statistically significant (Amtrak op-ed on Veterans outcome).

Table 7 estimates four op-ed effects on each of four composite scales, so it holds 16 coefficients, of which four are on target and 12 are not. The parallel sentence about Table 3 counts correctly: five op-eds by five outcomes is 25 coefficients and 20 non-target ones.

4. The number of elite subjects who completed the survey

This procedure yielded 2,169 subjects who completed our survey.

Corrected:

This procedure yielded **2,181** subjects who completed our survey.

Table 5, at the top of the same page, gives 2,181 as its own total, and that is the number of rows in the deposited elite data. Tables 6 and 7 report the same figure as their N.

5. The number of elite subjects who responded in Wave 2

As in the MTurk study, we asked subjects to participate in a follow-up survey after 10 days; after two reminders, we obtained 1,349 complete responses.

Corrected:

As in the MTurk study, we asked subjects to participate in a follow-up survey after 10 days; after two reminders, we obtained **1,358** complete responses.

Table 5's Responded row totals 1,358.

6. The number of subjects enrolled on Mechanical Turk

We enrolled 3,567 subjects on Amazon's Mechanical Turk (MTurk) in a three-wave panel survey.

Corrected:

We enrolled **3,571** subjects on Amazon's Mechanical Turk (MTurk) in a three-wave panel survey.

Table 1 gives 3,571 as its own total, and every column of Tables 3 and 4 reports the same figure as its N.